Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026
Assignment: IT265 Case Study - Personal Choice
Student: Abiodun O. (ao433)
Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 81%
Potential Grade: 8.13/10.00 (81.30%)
Received Grade: 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)
Started: 5/4/2026 4:44:29 PM
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Grading Link: https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/grading/ao433
View Link: https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/view/ao433

Instructions

Step 1: Pick a game you plan to analyze

Step 2: Playtest your game choice (or review streamers playing the game)

Step 3: Analyze, research, and review your chosen game. Collect resources (website links, etc that you used during the exploration) include these with the responses in the related sections. Fill in the responses of the below prompts/checklist/etc.

Step 4: Export the PDF. Upload it to Github and upload the same PDF to Canvas.

Section #1: (1.25 pts.) Game Overview

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Historical Context and Game Description

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Game's title, developer, publisher, platform, and release date.
- Historical context of the game's release and its place in the industry.
- Game's genre and how it compares to similar games of the time.

Your Response:

Qbert is an action video game that debuted on October 18, 1982 developed and published by Gottlieb for arcades. This is Gottlieb's only video game that garned massive critical and commercial success and in retrospect is considered to be one of

the most high profile titles of the classic era. Qbert's big splash and appeal in the market is similar to other games of its genre like Pac-Man and Donkey Kong due to the emphasis on characters, animations, story lines, and the "absence of violence" too.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Gameplay Mechanics

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the core gameplay mechanics and how they shape the player's experience.
- Explain how players control the game and interact with it.
- Identify and describe any unique aspects or creative elements in the game's gameplay.

Your Response:

Qbert is an action game with puzzle elements that has the player control Qbert who can only move diagonally on a 28 cube map. The player must guide Qbert by landing a cube to change its color to match the required color the game's asking to progress to the next stage. There are several enemy types in the game (Coily, Ugg, Wrongway, Slick, and Sam) and if the player leads Qbert to contact a purple enemy that's a life lost while greeen ones are removed upon contact. Colored balls appear on the board which upon contact with a red one will result in a life lost while a green one just immobilizes the on-screen enemies for a brief time. Multicolored floating discs can be located on either side of the pyramid servivng as an escape from danger to transport Qbert on top of the pyramid. All these mechanics combined make this game multifaceted and deep compared to most of its comtemporaries at the time leading to why it got so popular in the first place.

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Section #2: (1.25 pts.) Software Architecture And Technology

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Technical Framework

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game engine and any special software (middleware) used to make

the game. Explain why these were important for making the game work.
- List the programming languages and software tools used to build the game. Discuss how these tools helped in creating the game's features.

Your Response:

Qbert was wriiten in 8088 assembly language and was started with a framework given by Tim Skelly for the game Reactor. Games in the 80s usually had to be written this way despite C and C++ existing due to the amount of limited storage systems like arcade cabinets had so using material that could greatly lower the size of a game in order to render compatible for the system you're working towards was paramount. Qbert also had its development moved to the first available IBM PC but it initally started on an Intel development system dubbed by the developers THE BLUE BOX. It was 5 times the size of modern PCs with a blue color and 9 inch floppy disks.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Innovations and Challenges

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Identify and describe any new or unique technical features in the game. Explain how these features made the game different or improved it.
- Discuss any major difficulties the developers encountered while making the game. Describe how they solved these problems.

Your Response:

Kan Yabumoto was a programmer on the project that one time filled a screen with hexagons that consisted of 3 different colored diamonds. It then hit him if he removed some of those shapes so the screen can look like a pyramid of cubes floating in space. Followed by bouncing balls inhabiting the environment via randomly going in any direction lended people remarking how cool and 3-dimensional it looked. Jeff Lee created the character sprites for the game via plopping each pixel in each image one at a time. Jeff made little things when dealing with character sprites like making an image of Qbert bending his knees to absorb the shock he took from a jump between cubes. This kind of thing bred life into the characters. The knocker that would vibrate the cabinet upon Qbert's disappearence from the bottom of the screen was Rick Tighe to make the effect feel fantastic towards the player's experience. Qbert originally shot projectiles from his nose but the feature was scrapped due to Warreb Davis favoring more simpler control schemes in games and instead focused the game around saving the protagonist from peril. The first tech demo had mixed responses from players due to how some players found how difficult the control scheme was. This caused some players to plunge to their deaths by jumping off the bottom of the screen while others adpated to the scheme overtime. This outcome caused the devs to lower the game's level of difficulty in the final release.

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Section #3: (1.25 pts.) Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Mechanics Analysis

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Explore and describe the main rules and actions that players use in the game. Explain how these core mechanics define the game's playstyle.
- Discuss how the game's core mechanics keep players interested and involved. Describe the ways these mechanics make the game fun or challenging.

Your Response:

Players must hop on a series of cube platforms to color match the required color threshold to progress the next stage all while collecting collectibles to achieve a high score and avoid perilous obstacles in the process too. The 2 former objectives render the game into a checklist-like collectathon playstyle where collecting anything out of those objectives is seen as an reward in of itself and gives off a sense of progression propelling the player to further engage with the game longer. The latter acts as a difficulty setting for the player's experience and incentivizes them to bypass any danger they encounter to keep playing the game and maintain their continously streak they've been holding.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Level Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the design of the game's levels or environments. Focus on the layout, obstacles, and visual elements, and how they contribute to the game's setting.
- Explain how the level or environment design affects the way players play the game. Discuss how these design choices impact the overall experience, such as creating challenges, guiding the player, or setting the mood.

Your Response:

The level design is made of small 28 cubes to form a floating pyramind which inhabits

color changing platforms, devillsh enemies to avoid, hapless enemies to be stepped on, and collectibles to collect. The layout of the composition makes it seems like a otherworldly casino pyramid floating in outer space with vibrant colors and simplisic creatures and items you'd find in a real life casino. This clever design layout guides players to play around within the confines of the colorful pyramid and to step on every cube for color change stimulation in order to complete the board and move onto the next stage.

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Section #4: (1.25 pts.) Graphic And Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Graphic and Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's visual appearance and the artistic choices made. Discuss elements like color, art style, and thematic consistency, and how they contribute to the game's overall look and feel.
- Discuss the design of the game's characters and environments. Focus on aspects such as realism, creativity, and how they fit within the game's world. Explain how these designs enhance the player's immersion in the game.

Your Response:

ws The game's vibrant colors emanating from the board you traverse through contrasted with character sprites having a defined color scheme as to not get lost in the environment makes for a game that appears to be in a psychedelic dream. The game takes advantage of the arcade cabinet's full range of colors and such a colorful game will no doubt leave an impression to the player allowing them to interpret what the game represents to them.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's sound design, focusing on the music and sound effects. Describe how they are used and their quality. Discuss any memorable or unique

audio elements in the game.

- Explain how the game's audio contributes to its overall mood and setting. Discuss how sound and music influence the player's emotional response and enhance the gaming experience.

Your Response:

The game's sound design is brilliantly orchestrated with a myriad of retro style sounds you'd come to expect from an 80s game but there some distinctive audio choices that help make the game stand out. From Qbert making noises based on what he interacts in the environment, to Ugg and Wrongway making noises upon entering the screen, to sheer screeching sound heard when an entity falls off the board, creates such a harmonious audiovisual experince for player to be enriched by what they're listening to,

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Section #5: (1.25 pts.) User Interface And User Experience

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - User Interface and User Experience

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the layout of the game's user interface (UI) and how it functions. Discuss elements like menus, icons, and on-screen prompts, and how they help players navigate and understand the game.
- Evaluate how well the game's UI communicates important information to players. Discuss aspects such as clarity, readability, and the ability of the UI to provide necessary game details without overwhelming or confusing the player.

Your Response:

The UI choices this game is quite simple and perceptible for players of all ages to understand without it being a hassle. The top right screen displays the player's number and what color they have to change the whole board into while the top left screen showcases the current level and round your on too. One aspect that's really neat for the player's experience is there are arrows accompanying the cube color you need to change the board to with the words "CHANGE TO:". This UI choice perfectly illustrates what the player's objective is at all times.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - UX Analysis

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the overall feel of playing the game, focusing on how different aspects of the game contribute to the player's experience. Analyze how these elements, such as ease of use, game flow, and feedback, affect the gameplay.
- Evaluate the design decisions made to enhance the player's experience. Consider factors like tutorial design, learning curve, and player engagement. Discuss how effective these choices are in making the game enjoyable and accessible to players.

Your Response:

This game appropriately orients itself in being an action puzzle game by having the player traversing the environment to color match the entire board while avoiding unfavorable in a breakneck pace fashion. At the start of the game, it eases the player in by introducing small gameplay features and gradually ramp up the on-screen elements the player will face once they get used to the gameplay loop. This methodology makes the game accessible to players who memorize its structure and are rewarded with harder progression to test their skills in.

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Section #6: (1.25 pts.) Narrative And Storytelling

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Narrative Structure

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's story, including its narrative structure, main plot points, and the setting in which it takes place. Discuss how these elements come together to create a cohesive and engaging story.
- Analyze the storytelling techniques used in the game, such as dialogue, cutscenes, or environmental storytelling. Evaluate how effectively these techniques convey the story and engage the player.

Your Response:

Unfortunately, The video game Qbert has no story to speak of all and is only known by the titular character jumping through cubes and yelling grawlixes when colliding with an enemy. However, the minimalistic approach to storytelling can allow players to

make their interpretations from the characters and visuals of Qbert. For example, the player can imagine Qbert being stranded out in space on a floating pyramid and has to survive from the clutches of aliens ready to attack him at any means necessary. There's multiple routes the story can take from experiencing the gameplay alone and having your imagination blossom into any which way you want.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Character and Integration

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the development of the game's characters. Describe their roles within the story, their personalities, and how they evolve throughout the game. Consider how the characters contribute to the overall narrative.
- Examine how the game's narrative and characters are integrated into the gameplay. Discuss how story elements are woven into the game mechanics and how this integration affects the player's experience.

Your Response:

The characters of Qbert was created by Jeff Lee with the artist drawing a complete concept sketch of the game thinking the team could make the game from looking at the sketch alone. It depicted an orange armless main character, which would later be called Qbert, shooting mucus bombs at purple enemies that got dubbed Ugg and Wrongway. All character preseneted in the sketch and thought of as development progressed were inspired by comics, cartoons, Mad magazine, and by artist Ed"Big Daddy"Roth. Qbert's famous grawlix in a sppech bubble came from Lee presenting it as a joke.

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Section #7: (1.25 pts.) Impact And Reception

Progress: 50%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Reception and Impact

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Research and summarize how the game was received by critics and players. Include key reviews, ratings, and player feedback. Discuss any notable praise or criticism the game received.
- Analyze the game's impact on the gaming industry. Discuss how it may have influenced game design, trends, or inspired other games. Consider any lasting

influenced game design, trends, or inspired other games. Consider any lasting effects it has had on the industry.

Your Response:

Qbert was a smash hit success receptively and commercially, selling around 25K arcade cabinets. The game was received favorably once exposed to a wider industry audience at the November 1982 AMOA show, one month after its release. Video Games magazine placed Qbert in its list of Top Ten Hits, describing it as "the most unusual and exciting game of the show. The Coin Slot reported "Gottlieb's game, Q*BERT, was one of the stars of the show", and remarked that "The game should do very well". Electronic Games considered it " a potential Arcade Award winner for coin-op game of the year', praising innovative gameplay and outstanding graphics which they later did exactly that on the same year. Qbert is recognized to be signnificant part of videogame history. News outlets and authors remarked it as a memorable classic and there were plently applause to Qbert's design itself, with the authors of High Score! referring him as an "ultra-endearing alien hopmeister", and the cutest game character of 1982.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Cultural Significance

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Examine the game's cultural significance and the legacy it has left behind. Discuss how the game has been remembered over time and its status in the gaming community.
- Describe the game's presence and representation in media, such as films, books, or online content. Discuss its role in fan communities and any influence it has had on broader cultural aspects, such as art, music, or social trends.

Your Response:

Qbert was deeply remembered fondly in the gaming circle with it's addictive gameplay loop and pivotal 3-dimensional level design by critics and fans alike. The character Qbert's likeness was used in all sorts of merchandising such as appearing on lunch boxes, toys, cereal boxes, and an his very own animated television on the Saturday Supercade program. Several years later, Qbert would make an appearance in Disney's Wreck-It Ralph and Sony's Pixels.

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Section #8: (1.25 pts.) Reflection

Progress: 0%

Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Describe your personal experience playing the chosen game

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Was it "fun"? What made it fun or not fun?
- Is this genre/game-type aligned with personal interests?
- What made you pick this game? Was it a good choice?

Your Response:

I played Qbert for about 10 minutes and it didn't really click with me all that well. It's control scheme as difficult as reviewers and players stated in the past and quickly got little peeved when I kept dying off the board or to ana incoming enemy nearby. It is a game that's aligned in my interests but I really wouldn't sing its praises with the experience I had from it. I only picked Qbert for my project because the titular character is cute and he quickly came to mind as I vividly remember seeing him first in the movie Wreck-It Ralph as a kid.

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Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Assignment Reflection

Progress: 0%

Details:

- What interesting or new "thing(s)" did you learn during your research and analysis?
- Did you find it was easy to come across the information you were looking for? What was your primary means of research/analysis?

Your Response:

The interesting thing I've learned in this research paper was how creative developers are when they're at odds with their resources and improvise on the fly to create some of the most brilliant features possible. No matter how simple or weird ideas that come up to the surface are, having a united vision and believing in it can come a long way even if you small tweaks that doesn't compromise it all. I used Wikipedia and another website called Coinop.org which had an article named "The Creation of Qbert" as my primary sources for researching this video game.

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